

Tyler Walters

Platform Engineering | AI Transformation | Enterprise Architecture

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Technology leader with 20+ years leading engineering transformations spanning cloud modernization, platform engineering, and enterprise AI adoption. Builds organizations, platforms, and engineering systems that enable companies to scale effeciently and responsibly.

- 20+ years leading engineering organizations and enterprise architecture
- Ex-Amazon SDE & architect building and operating hyperscale distributed systems
- Built and scaled performant engineering teams from startup through enterprise
- Led cloud and AI transformations across healthcare, retail, SaaS and Fortune 500 clients
- Created agent deployment, observability, security, guardrail and HITL approval system
- Introduced autonomous AI software delivery in a controlled HIPAA/SOC2 environment
- Actively hands on with critical development and operational activities.

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Master of Business Administration
2004 • Oregon State University
• MBA Association Treasurer

Bachelor of Computer Science
2002 • Oregon State University
• Linux User Group VP

Current Experience

Claritas Rx • Director of Platform Architecture • San Francisco, CA (Remote Portland)

2024 → Present • Digital health SaaS company building the Ascend platform for specialty biopharmaceutical data intelligence. Progressed from Principal Architect to Director of Data Platform Engineering to Director of Platform Architecture, reporting directly to the CTO.

Technology Strategy

- Defined Ascend Data & SaaS platform technical roadmap with CTO, aligning engineering investment to business growth.
- Created SDLC using trunk-based multi-language monorepo with app and infrastructure CICD pieplines.
- Transformed legacy data services to SaaS product model, unlocking Ascend 2.0 as a commercially scalable platform.

AI Transformation

- Established enterprise AI strategy and governance framework enabling autonomous SDLC within HIPAA/SOC2 compliance.
- Deployed AI coding tools, agentic workflow automations and guardrails governing the company AI stack.
- Established usage policies enabling engineers to leverage AI safely across all development workflows.

Platform Engineering

- Scaled new Data Ingestion Platform to 45 biopharma customers, 425 data partners and ~2k data sets processing ~20GB incoming data/day.
- Built internal developer automations reducing engineer onboarding from 4w to ~3d with automated provisioning, sandboxes and tooling.
- Setup Ascend 2.0 SaaS foundations with AWS Organizations landing zone, Control Tower and Transit GW cross-account networking.
- Designed HIPAA/SOC2 data tagging and migrated data transformation to AWS Glue and PySpark ETL using common pyspark libs and CI/CD.

Organizational Leadership

- Helped grow team from 8 to 45 through structured hiring, onboarding automation and career coaching.
- Led 16-person engineering team as Director of Data Platform Engineering to execute on product roadmap and support operations.

Prior Experience

Roar Social • Backend Software Architect • Los Angeles, CA (Remote Portland)

2022 → 2024 • Transformed a POC demo app into a secure, scalable, production-ready social platform in 9 months, leading architecture design and backend implementation with a team of 25 engineers.

- Scaled content delivery APIs to 100K TPS at <50ms average latency.
- Established operational excellence program — dashboards, runbooks and auto-generated ticketing on metric anomalies and log errors.
- Built event-driven personalized feed generation, content discovery and donation flow systems.

Amazon • Cloud Application Architect • Portland, OR

2018 → 2022 • Held multiple engineering roles across Amazon and AWS, architecting hyperscale distributed systems and leading enterprise modernization engagements.

Hyperscale Distributed Systems

- Scaled data routing service to 340K TPS at 50ms latency managing 1.6 TB of seller inventory data from 14 high-volume event sources.
- Led modernization of 160+ data clients across 90 teams, driving 30% reduction in high-severity tickets.

Enterprise Modernization

- Defined microservices modernization roadmap for a C# monolith serving millions of AWS Training students.
- Scaled LMS to 50K TPS for re:Invent; led EU cookie consent compliance across all AWS training web properties.
- Led cloud-native engagements for Whole Foods Market, DoorDash and Portland General Electric.

Executive Technical Leadership

- Certified AWS Speaker; delivered technical guidance and architecture direction to Fortune 500 executive stakeholders.
- Built voice-UI testing framework for Drive-Through Automation R&D with Alexa Music Skills.

Nike • Tech Lead, Trial Zone • Portland, OR

2016 → 2018 • Scaled an agency-created retail experience POC to 8 flagship Nike locations across US, Europe and China, supporting digitally enhanced AR running and basketball experiences.

- Built CI/CD for on-site server fleet with Kinect sensors, video streams and game engines supported by cloud monitoring.
- Scaled system from single POC to 8 global flagship locations through automated site-specific configuration.

Consulting Experience

Slalom Consulting • Solution Principal • Chicago, IL

2010 → 2016 • Business and technology consulting firm. Progressed from Consultant to Solution Architect to Solution Principal. Co-founded a DevOps-focused delivery practice and led cloud modernization engagements across enterprise clients.

- Co-founded DevOps practice; built and led a team of 9 SDE consultants across cloud modernization and SaaS delivery engagements.
- Led pursuit and delivery of 7 projects generating $8M+ revenue; project oversight for up to 22 developers.
- Influenced client executives on cloud-first strategy through bootcamps, tech talks and conference presentations.

Hitachi Consulting • Senior Consultant • Portland, OR

2006 → 2010 • Led end-to-end delivery of transformation programs across Education, Healthcare, Retail, Finance, Manufacturing and Distribution. Delivered cloud and data modernization for enterprise clients using .NET, Java and MSBI stacks.

WitMatix Web Development Services • Founder • Corvallis, OR

2004 → 2006 • Founded and operated a web development and online services company, managing local and outsourced teams to deliver custom applications and e-commerce systems.

Past Client Engagements

Qlik Technologies • Led architecture and initial operations of QlikCloud.com, transforming an enterprise hosted service into an on-demand SaaS in under a year. Delivered a globally distributed, HA and auto-scaling platform on AWS.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Michigan • Led new member portal for 22 developers using IaC and CI/CD to automate environment setup and accelerate delivery.

Western Governors University • Designed a Data CI pipeline defining data as code to accelerate data platform delivery.

Echo Global Logistics • Integrated an acquired IT stack using IaC and cloud-native approaches to unify infrastructure and operations.

Law Bulletin • Led cloud vendor selection and migrated JuraLaw on-premise stack to AWS, improving consistency, agility and DR capability.

Providence Health & Services • Partnered with Director of Healthcare Intelligence to establish BI governance and deliver first pilot data mart projects.

Walgreens • Delivered time-sensitive data de-identification system to meet compliance deadlines across pharmacy data flows.

Pepsi • Defined vending machine metrics infrastructure as code on AWS to enable operational analytics.

Additional engagements spanning Nike, Standard Insurance, Russell Investments, Columbia Sportswear, Waste Management, Johnstone Supply, Cascade Corporation, Microsoft, CorVel Software, Knowledge Learning Corporation

Certifications

AWS Certified SysOps Administrator
2021 • Amazon Web Services

AWS Certified Developer Associate
2019 • Amazon Web Services

AWS Certified Solutions Architect
2018 • Amazon Web Services

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
2017 • Amazon Web Services

Skills

Leadership
Executive Leadership
Technology Strategy
Organizational Design
Platform Engineering
AI Transformation
Operational Excellence

Technical
Distributed Systems
Cloud Platforms
Data Platforms
Developer Experience
Enterprise Architecture

Languages
Python
TypeScript
Go
Java/Kotlin
HTML/CSS

Publications

Qlik Cloud Case Studies [Link 1] [Link 2] [Link 3] [Link 4]
2015 • The QlikCloud.com solution showcased by Qlik, Slalom and AWS for how the thick client software was converted to social SaaS, the rapid implementation time and its global scaling elasticity.

DrupalCon: Case Studies in Social Commerce [Link 1] [Link 2]
2010 • Co-presented on how WM used Drupal in Greenopolis.com and ThinkGreenRewards.wm.com.

Microsoft VisioToolbox.com: Green IT How-Tos and Code [Link 1] [Link 2] [Link 3]
2009 • How-Tos and code from creating a workshop and CD distribution using MS Visio for Green IT.

Weatherford Entrepreneurship Incubator [Link 1] [Link 2]
2004 • Founded WitMatix.com web development services in the OSU entrepreneurship incubator.